UNIVERSITY WORK-EXPERIENCE PROJECT

CheckFirst

A calmer next step when a message, link or phone call feels wrong.

Social engineering guidance for everyday users

Company and community pilot proposal · September 2026

THE USER PROBLEM

Pressure arrives in familiar places

An urgent email.
A delivery text.
A convincing caller.
A QR code at the wrong moment.

People need an understandable explanation before they respond.

THE EXPERIENCE

Understand the warning. Choose the next step.

01	**Bring the concern**	A link, message, .eml email, phone number or QR image.
02	**Read the explanation**	See the warning signs and what the tool could not check.
03	**Verify independently**	Use a known contact channel before sharing information or paying.

FICTIONAL DEMONSTRATION

“Your parcel is on hold”

“Confirm your details and pay now. parcel-help.example/verify.”

What to examine

Payment pressure, a request for personal details and an unfamiliar domain.

What to do next

Open the delivery company’s known website or contact it using details you already trust.

Illustrative explanation. The reserved .example address is plain text and must not be visited.

HONEST RESULTS

A useful explanation includes its limits

01 Warning signs need context.

02 Caller identity cannot be proved by a number.

03 No warning found does not mean safe.

04 Unavailable checks remain visible.

Live phishing intelligence is disabled in this version.

PRIVACY BY DESIGN

Analysis starts on the user’s device

Within the browser

Local analysis of submitted content.

No application database.

No account required to try the tool.

Before sharing a report

Use the redacted export.

Check it for identifying details.

Share only what is needed.

Email content is treated as text. Remote email images and suspicious links are not opened automatically.

DELIVERY MODEL

A small service footprint

COMPONENT	PURPOSE	CURRENT SCOPE
Browser application	Explain local warning signs	No external account needed
GitHub	Source and automated checks	Owner connection pending
Cloudflare Pages	Website and source-status route	Deployment pending
Phishing feed	Potential future evidence	Disabled
Supabase	No current requirement	Not used

Free-tier deployment is the starting assumption. Account terms and usage still apply.

POTENTIAL PARTNER VALUE

A conversation starter for safer habits

01	**For employees**	Explain a suspicious request in accessible language.
02	**For educators**	Demonstrate warning signs using fictional scenarios.
03	**For support teams**	Help a user describe what concerned them.

These benefits are hypotheses for a pilot. Impact has not yet been measured.

PROPOSED PILOT

Test comprehension before expansion

One supervised workshop

Invite a small voluntary group.

Use fictional links, messages and email files.

Observe the steps users find confusing.

Questions to measure

Can users explain one warning sign?

Do they understand an incomplete check?

Can they choose an independent verification step?

Agree the evaluation and university requirements before recruitment. Collect feedback without raw submissions.

A project with reviewable deliverables

01	**Working product**	A local application with fictional examples and clear limitations.
02	**Reproducible setup**	Source, dependency lockfile, automated checks and deployment guidance.
03	**Evidence for improvement**	A verification checklist and a proposal for user feedback.

THE INVITATION

Help make the next step clearer

We are seeking a pilot partner to review the language, try fictional scenarios and share structured feedback.

A small workshop. A defined audience.
A clear decision about what to improve next.

Next meeting: agree the audience, facilitator and success criteria.